71 Suffixes: forming nouns

A Verb + noun suffix

Suffixes are used at the ends of words; they often tell you if a word is a noun, a verb, an adjective or an adverb. Two suffixes which form nouns from verbs are **-ion** and **-ment**.

verb	noun
invent [produce or design something completely new]	**invention**
discuss [talk about something seriously]	**discussion**
translate [change from one language to another]	**translation**
relax [rest, and feel calm and comfortable]	**relaxation**
improve [get better]	**improvement**
govern [control the affairs of a city or country]	**government**
manage [direct or control a business]	**management**
develop [grow or change and become more advanced]	**development**

His latest **invention** is a new board game.
Relaxation will help you to sleep better.
We had a **discussion about** politics.

The **management** has to change.
I need money for more **development**.
We need an **improvement in** the weather.

B Adjective + noun suffix

The suffixes **-ness** and **-ity** often form nouns from adjectives.

adjective	noun
weak (*opp* strong)	**weakness**
happy	**happiness**
ill [sick, not well]	**illness**
fit [in good condition, usually because of exercise]	**fitness**
stupid (*opp* intelligent, clever)	**stupidity**
popular [liked by a lot of people]	**popularity**
similar [almost the same; *opp* different]	**similarity**
able	**ability** (*opp* **inability**)

What is his main **weakness** as a manager?
Snowboarding is growing in **popularity**.
I'm frustrated by my **inability to** use computers.

Fortunately it wasn't a serious **illness**.
There is a **similarity between** them.
Her **happiness** is all that matters to me.

C *-er, -or* and *-ist*

These suffixes can be added to nouns or verbs. They often describe people and jobs.

-er	*-or*	*-ist*
ballet **dancer**	company **director**	**artist**, e.g. Picasso
pop **singer**	**translator**	**economist**
professional **footballer**	film **actor**	**scientist**

Language help

Adding a suffix to a verb, adjective or noun may change the position of the main stress, e.g. re'lax – relax'ation, 'stupid – stu'pidity, eco'nomics – e'conomist.
(The ' symbol is before the syllable with the main stress.)

Exercises

71.1 **Complete the tables and mark the stress on each word. (Stress is marked on the pronunciation of a word in a dictionary.) The last two in each column are not on the opposite page, but do you know or can you guess the noun formed from them?**

verb	noun
dis'cuss	*dis'cussion*
improve	
invent	
relax	
hesitate	
arrange	

adjective	noun
stupid	
happy	
similar	
popular	
sad	
active	

71.2 **Write down the names of the people who do these things as a job.**

1 sing opera music *opera singers*
2 act in films .....
3 important managers in a company .....
4 change words from one language into another .....
5 play football .....
6 dance in ballets .....
7 paint pictures .....
8 work in science .....

71.3 **Complete the text using words from the box with the correct suffix and spelling. One word also needs a prefix.**

~~weak~~	improve	govern	economics	able	manage	discuss

"In his speech last night, the prime minister said that the present [1] *weakness* of the economy was caused by the bad [2] ..... of the last [3] ..... and their [4] ..... to give the right kind of help for industry. He said he was now involved in detailed [5] ..... with ministers, bankers and [6] ..... about a range of different financial measures, and he hoped the people would be able to see a big [7] ..... in the economy by the end of the year."

71.4 **Complete the dialogues.**

1 A: He hasn't been well at all, has he?
B: No, it's quite a serious *illness* .
2 A: Are they almost the same?
B: Yes, the ..... is amazing.
3 A: Has anyone made anything like this before?
B: No, it's a brand-new ..... .
4 A: Is her new novel going to be published in other languages?
B: Yes, someone is working on a ..... right now.
5 A: Does your daughter enjoy drawing too?
B: Yes, she's a very good ..... .
6 A: Javier gets tired after he's been playing for about ten minutes.
B: I know. If he wants to be in the team, he'll have to improve his ..... .
7 A: Do you think the organisation can still grow?
B: Yes, I think there is an opportunity for further ..... .

72 Suffixes: forming adjectives

Common suffixes that form adjectives include: **-able** (comfortable), **-al** (musical), **-y** (cloudy), **-ous** (famous) and **-ive** (attractive).

A *-al*

Adjectives ending **-al** are usually formed from nouns, and often mean 'relating to the noun', e.g. a **musical** instrument (from music), a **political** issue (from politics), an **electrical** fault (related to electricity), a **personal** opinion (the opinion of one person).

SHICHI-GO-SAN

Shichi-Go-San (meaning 7, 5, 3) is an **annual** ceremony in Japan for three-and seven-year-old girls, and three-and five-year-old boys. It is on November 15, but it is not a **national**[1] holiday, so people often have it on the nearest weekend. Seven, five and three are seen as important years in the growth of a child, and the numbers also have **cultural significance**[2] because odd numbers (1, 3, 5, 7, 9, etc.) are lucky in Japan. This is one of the special days when the older boys and girls are allowed to wear **traditional**[3] clothes: a kimono for girls and hakama trousers for boys. Now it is quite **normal**[4] for children to wear western-style clothes at this ceremony. The children visit a shrine and are then given special sweets called *Chitose-Ame* by their parents.



[1] a holiday for the whole country
[2] they are important in Japanese culture
[3] in a style that has continued for many years
[4] usual

B *-able* /əbl/

This suffix forms adjectives from nouns *and* verbs, and the prefix **un-** often forms the opposite:
an **enjoyable** party [something that you enjoyed]
a **comfortable** chair (*opp* **uncomfortable**)
a **suitable** word or phrase [right/correct for a particular situation; *opp* **unsuitable**]
a **reliable** service; reliable information [able to be trusted or believed; *opp* **unreliable**]
fashionable clothes [popular now with many people; *opp* **unfashionable**]
a **reasonable** decision or price [fair; not a bad decision or price; *opp* **unreasonable**]
a **sociable** person [enjoys being with people; *opp* **unsociable**]

Sometimes the opposite form is the more common adjective:
an **unforgettable** experience [something that cannot be forgotten]
an **unbelievable** story [something that is very surprising and very difficult to believe]

C *-ful* and *-less*

The suffix **-ful** often means 'full of' or 'having the quality of the noun', e.g. a **colourful** room has a lot of colour in it; a **helpful** person gives a lot of help; a **peaceful** place is calm and quiet. The opposite meaning is sometimes formed by adding the suffix **-less** to the noun.
a **useful** machine [having a lot of uses; *opp* a **useless** machine]
a **painful** injection [giving pain and being unpleasant; *opp* a **painless** injection]
a **careful** driver [drives with care and attention; *opp* a **careless** driver]

Common mistakes

The suffix is **-ful** (NOT ~~full~~), so **useful** and **careful** (NOT ~~usefull~~ or ~~carefull~~).

Exercises

72.1 **Correct the spelling mistakes. Be careful: one word is correct.**

1 enjoiable *enjoyable*
2 carful .....
3 relyable .....
4 peacefull .....
5 confortable .....
6 anual .....
7 unforgetable .....
8 reasonable .....
9 unbeleivable .....

72.2 **Match the words on the left with the words on the right.**

1 a national	[d]	a injection
2 a useful	[ ]	b mistake
3 a painful	[ ]	c price
4 fashionable	[ ]	d holiday
5 a careless	[ ]	e man
6 an electrical	[ ]	f bit of advice
7 an unsociable	[ ]	g clothes
8 a reasonable	[ ]	h fault

72.3 **Write an adjective formed from these nouns or verbs. 11–15 are not on the opposite page, but you can find them in the index if you don't know them.**

1 tradition *traditional*
2 attract .....
3 person .....
4 cloud .....
5 colour .....
6 fame .....
7 electricity .....
8 politics .....
9 enjoy .....
10 nation .....
11 wind .....
12 danger .....
13 create .....
14 emotion .....
15 fog .....

72.4 **Tick (✓) the words which form opposites with the suffix *-less*.**

wonderful *No (~~wonderless~~)*	useful	beautiful
careful	painful	peaceful

72.5 **Complete the sentences.**

1 You must be very *careful* when you drive in wet weather.
2 She told us an ..... story about a dog that could speak.
3 The tourist information office was very ....., and told us everything we needed to know.
4 The festival is an ..... event, held on the first Monday in September.
5 It was very ..... when I hit my leg against the corner of that table.
6 This bag is ..... ; it's too small for me to put anything in it.
7 We've never had any problems with our TV in ten years; it's been very ..... .
8 Most people agreed with it, so I think it was a ..... decision.
9 This is just my ..... opinion; others may not agree.
10 Travelling round China and the Far East was an ..... experience.
11 Children perform ..... dances at the ceremony, as they have done for hundreds of years.
12 Do you think this dress is ..... for a wedding?

72.6 **Choose three adjectives from the opposite page which could describe these people or things.**

1 a village: *attractive*, *famous*, *peaceful*
2 a jacket: ....., ..., ...
3 an event: ....., ..., ...
4 a person you know: ....., ..., ...
5 an opinion: ....., ..., ...
6 a room: ....., ..., ...

73 Compound nouns

A Formation

We form compound nouns by putting two words together (or three) to create a new idea. Compound nouns are very common in English.

Ice hockey is a game of hockey played on ice.
Public transport is transport that can be used by the public**.**
A **campsite** is a **site** for camping. [a place used for a special purpose]
A **babysitter** is someone who looks after young children when their parents go out.
Income tax is money you pay to the government out of your **income** [the total amount of money you receive every year from your work and other places].
Your **mother tongue** is the first language you learn as a child.
A **travel agent** is someone whose job is to make travel arrangements for you.
A **film-maker** is someone who makes films for the cinema or television.
A **full stop** is a punctuation mark at the end of a sentence.
A **haircut** is the act of cutting someone's hair, e.g. *That boy needs a haircut*.


DJ (**disc jockey**)

hairdresser


hairdryer

wheelchair



toothpaste


toothbrush


sunglasses


chest of drawers


crossroads


cashpoint


traffic lights


earrings

B One word or two?

Some compound nouns are written as one word, e.g. **wheelchair;** a few are written with a hyphen, e.g. **T-shirt;** many are written as two words, e.g. **credit card, bus stop**. Use a dictionary to check if necessary.

C Pronunciation

The main stress is usually on the first part, e.g. '**haircut** or '**income tax**, but sometimes it is on the second part, e.g. **public** '**transport**, **full** '**stop**. Use a dictionary to check if necessary.

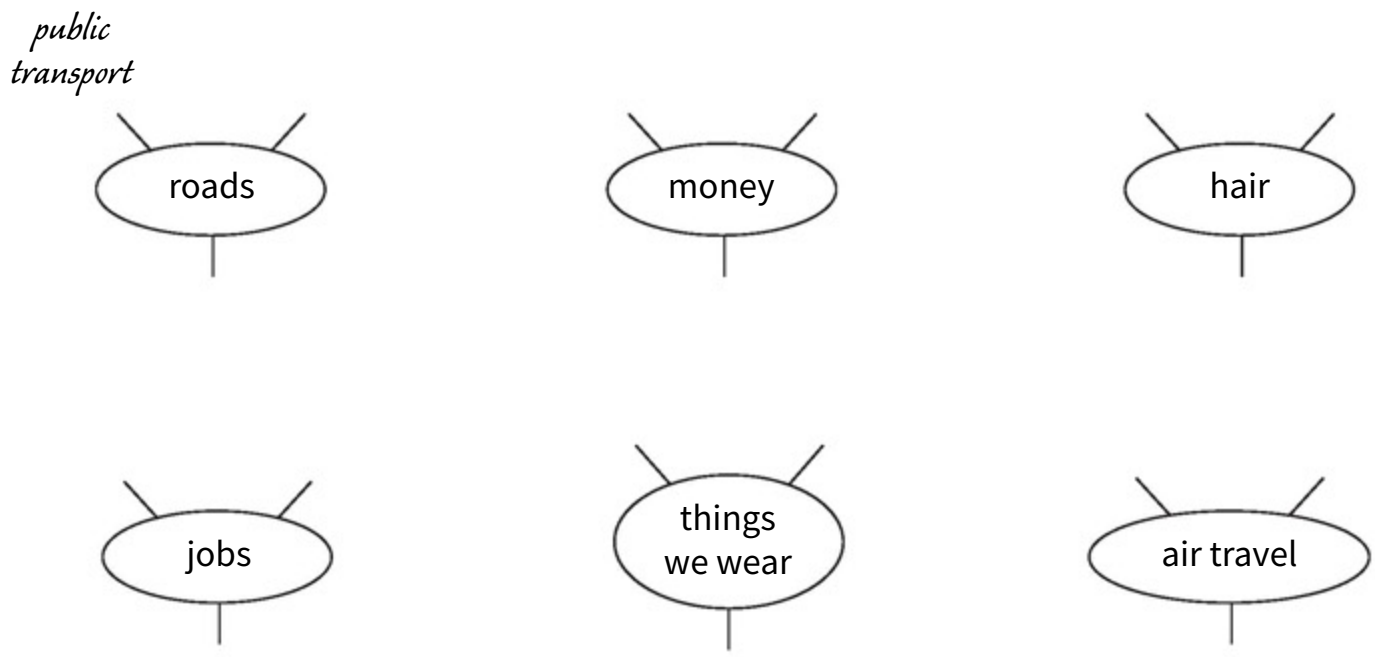
D Forming new compounds

One part of a compound often forms the basis for a number of compound nouns.

airport e.g. Heathrow	**bus driver**	**ID card (identity card)**
airline e.g. Lufthansa, KLM	**bus stop**	**credit card**
aircraft e.g. Airbus A380	**bus station**	**birthday card**

Exercises

73.1 Complete the circles with compound nouns from the opposite page.



73.2 Complete the sentences.

1 I got some money from the *cashpoint* .
2 I booked our holiday through a ..... .
3 We stayed on a very nice ..... , but unfortunately our tent wasn't really big enough.
4 He can't walk at all now, so he has to use a ..... to move around.
5 I sent her a ..... but she never received it; it must have got lost in the post.
6 Liz and Mark wanted to go out, but they couldn't find a ..... for the children.
7 When I'm driving I always wear ..... if it's very bright and sunny.
8 Most people have to pay ..... on their salary; the more you earn, the more you pay.
9 I washed my hair, then discovered that the ..... wasn't working.

73.3 Which words are being defined?

1 A substance that you use to clean your teeth. *toothpaste*
2 A piece of furniture for keeping clothes in. .....
3 Someone who plays music on the radio or at discos. .....
4 A card with your name, photograph and information to prove who you are. .....
5 The first language you learn as a child. .....
6 A game played on ice using sticks. .....
7 A punctuation mark at the end of a sentence. .....
8 A card you use to pay for things. .....

73.4 Make new compounds using one part of the compounds below. Answers for 1–6 are on the opposite page, answers for 7–12 are in other parts of the book.

1 airport *airline* .....
2 full stop .....
3 hairdresser .....
4 credit card .....
5 toothpaste .....
6 bus driver .....
7 living room .....
8 brother-in-law .....
9 sunglasses .....
10 traffic lights .....
11 wheelchair .....
12 film-maker .....

74 Word partners

A What do we mean by word partners?

If you want to use a word naturally, you often need to know other words that are commonly used with it. These are called word partners or collocations, and they can be different from language to language. For example:

I **spent time** in Paris. (NOT I ~~passed~~ time in Paris.) I **missed the bus**. (NOT I ~~lost~~ the bus.)
We **have** children. (NOT We ~~get~~ children.)

I **made** a mistake. (NOT I ~~did~~ a mistake.)
It was a **serious injury**. (also a **serious illness**)
It's **quite likely** that we'll stay here. [we'll probably stay here]
It **depends on** my parents. (NOT It depends ~~of~~ my parents. See Unit 77.)

Language help

More *word partners* can be found in the *Cambridge Learner's Dictionary* for intermediate learners and the *Cambridge Advanced Learner's Dictionary*.

B Verbs and nouns

There are many verbs and nouns that are often used together.

Pavel **told** me a **joke** but I can't remember it. [told me a funny story]
I need to **lose weight**. [become less heavy; *opp* **put on weight**]
The doctor told my father that he should **go on a diet**. [eat less in order to lose weight]
It's very difficult to **predict the future**. [say what will happen in the future]
We won the game 2–1, and my brother **scored** the first **goal**[1].
My neighbour's **alarm went off**[2] in the middle of the night.
They **fell in love** and got married. Now Emily is **expecting a baby**[3].

1



2



3



C Adjectives and nouns

Many adjectives and nouns are often used together. These are all examples where the meaning is 'big' or 'a lot', but where we usually use a particular adjective.

We've got a **large number** of students/tourists this year. (*opp* a **limited**/**small** number)
I will need a **large amount** of money.
There's a **wide choice** of food available. (*opp* a **limited**/**narrow** choice)
Sergio has a **wide vocabulary** in English. (*opp* a **limited vocabulary**)
It's only a toy gun but it makes a very **loud noise**.
Her family is of **great importance** to her.
We went to a party last night and it was **great fun** [very enjoyable; we enjoyed it a lot].
There was **heavy traffic** on the motorway going out of town. (*opp* **light** traffic)

D Adverbs and adjectives

The adverbs in the first three sentences mean *very,* the adverbs in the last sentence mean *fully*/*completely*. In each case, the adverbs and adjectives are common word partners.

I'm **terribly sorry** I'm late.
She's **well aware** of the problem. [She knows all about the problem.]
It's **vitally important** that we get the right person for the job.
Ava is **fast asleep**, but the other two are still **wide awake**.

Exercises

74.1 Correct the mistakes.

1 Why does she ~~do~~ so many mistakes? *make*
2 My sister got a baby last month. .....
3 I'm sorry I'm late; I lost the bus. .....
4 There was an accident and Tommy has a grave head injury. .....
5 I don't know if I can come – it depends of the weather. .....
6 We passed three days in Amsterdam. .....
7 I wouldn't like to try and say the future. .....
8 My sister is waiting for a baby next month. .....
9 Axel said me a very funny joke. .....
10 She gave us a big amount of money. .....

74.2 Complete the text.

My mum went to see the doctor, and he told her to go on a [1] *diet* . I think she knows that she needs to [2] ..... weight, but she's not happy about giving up chocolate. Anyway, I told her it's [3] ..... important that she keeps to the diet, because if she [4] ..... any more weight, it's quite [5] ..... that she'll end up with a more [6] ..... illness. Fortunately, I think she's [7] ..... aware of that.

74.3 Replace *big* or *little* with a more suitable adjective.

1 You won't need a ~~big~~ amount of money. *large*
2 Why are they making such a *big* noise? .....
3 I've got quite a *big* vocabulary in French. .....
4 There is only a *little* choice of things we can buy. .....
5 We had a very *big* number of tourists this year. .....
6 I think the event had *big* importance for her. .....
7 Isabel only has a *little* vocabulary in English. .....

74.4 Complete the sentences and dialogues.

1 A: Why were they late? B: They got stuck in *heavy* traffic.
2 When I went into her bedroom, she was ..... asleep.
3 A: Did you enjoy last night? B: Yes, it was ..... fun.
4 I met Sasha in town. She told me she's ..... a baby in June. Isn't that fantastic news?
5 A: We won 1–0. B: Who ..... the goal?
6 Mathis ..... me a joke, but I'm afraid I didn't understand it.
7 A: Are the boys asleep? B: No, they're still ..... awake.
8 My neighbour's burglar alarm ..... at 2 o'clock this morning and woke me up.
9 A: Why is she staying in Paris? B: She ..... in love with a French guy.
10 I'm ..... sorry, but I've lost your book – I'll buy you a new one.

74.5 Over to you

Look at the verbs and nouns in section B, and the adjectives and nouns in section C on the opposite page. Are they the same in your language? If possible, compare with someone else who speaks your language.

75 Fixed phrases

A What are fixed phrases?

There are many groups of words which you need to learn as complete phrases, because they often have a meaning which is different from the words on their own. Many of these are called idioms.

They arrived **out of the blue** [I didn't know they were coming; it was unexpected].
Does the name Merchant **ring a bell** [sound familiar]?
You'll have to **make up your mind** soon. [make a decision]

Some fixed phrases are easier to understand, but the same idea may be expressed in a different way in your language.

I think we'll have to **get rid of** some of this furniture. [remove it, e.g. sell it, throw it away, give it away, etc.]
I'm afraid I can't talk to you now; **I'm** (**just**) **about to** leave. [I am going to leave very soon]
I don't know what Martin said, but Natalie **burst into tears** [suddenly started crying]. She was very upset.
Everyone was there **apart from** Yasmine. [not including Yasmine; *syn* **except for**]



B Time phrases

He's leaving **in four days' time** [four days from now; also in three weeks'/six months'/two years' time, etc.].
I got here **the week before last** [during the week/month, etc. before the previous one].
The course is fine **so far** [up until now].
I rang our local doctor and fortunately she was able to come **at once** [now, immediately; *syns* **right away** / **straight away**].
He's so busy at work; he comes home late **night after night** [every night; also **day after day**, etc.].

C Pairs of words

A number of fixed phrases consist of two words, usually joined by **and**, and sometimes **or**.

I go to the theatre **now and again** [occasionally; *syns* **now and then**].
Andy had **one or two** [a few] suggestions.
I've got a house in the country, and I like to go there whenever possible for a bit of **peace and quiet** [a calm situation without noise].
I've been **up and down** the street, but I can't find their house. [first in one direction, then the other]
I've been to Paris **once or twice** [a few times].
I'll finish this report **sooner or later** [I don't know when, but I'll finish it].

D Introducing advice, opinions, etc.

Many fixed phrases are used to introduce advice, an opinion, an example, etc.

If I were you [in your situation], I'd accept the job they offered you.
In general [usually, or in most situations; *syn* **on the whole**] the summers are quite warm in this part of the country.
There were lots of questions. **For instance** [for example], how much will it cost?
I'm sure you'll have a great holiday. **By the way**, what time does the train leave? (used to introduce a new subject to the conversation)
To be honest, I didn't like her boyfriend very much. (used to say what you really think)

Exercises

75.1 **Using all the words in the square, find eight more phrases.**

~~ON~~	DAY	SOONER	~~AND~~	RIGHT
SO	AND	NOW	TWO	LATER
UP	OR	~~OFF~~	PEACE	AFTER
FAR	AND	ONE	AWAY	AGAIN
AND	DAY	QUIET	OR	DOWN

on and off ....
....
....

75.2 **Complete the sentences with one word, then underline the full fixed phrase in each sentence.**

1 She's been working on that essay night after *night* .
2 I'm arranging everything for next week. By the ..... , is your sister coming this evening?
3 My parents always turn up at my flat out of the ..... .
4 Some people enjoyed the book, but to be ..... , I thought it was boring.
5 I'd like to get ..... of these CDs because I don't listen to them any more.
6 In ..... , people are much happier when they have jobs that they enjoy.
7 I don't know what to do at the moment but I'll have to make up my ..... soon.
8 It's a flexible ticket. For ..... , you can use it during the week or at weekends.
9 Can I ring you later? I'm just ..... to have lunch.
10 If I ..... you, I'd get a new dictionary.

75.3 **Complete the fixed phrase in each dialogue.**

1 A: Do you go there much?
B: Now *and again* .
2 A: Have you had any ideas?
B: Yeah. One ..... .
3 A: Was she very upset?
B: Yes. She burst ..... .
4 A: You arrived ten days ago?
B: Yeah, the week ..... .
5 A: Should I accept the job?
B: Yes, I would if ..... .
6 A: Will they get here?
B: Yeah, sooner ..... .
7 A: Have you been there often?
B: Once ..... .
8 A: Do you need me there now?
B: Yes. Could you come at ..... ?
9 A: When are you going back?
B: In two weeks' ..... .
10 A: How's the course?
B: It's good so ..... .
11 A: I spoke to Chris Myler. Do you know him?
B: No, the name doesn't ring ..... .
12 A: Have you done all the housework?
B: Yes, apart ..... the washing.

75.4 **Here are more idioms. Can you underline one in each sentence, and guess what it means?**

1 I've been in the job a few days, but I already feel at home. *feel comfortable and relaxed*
2 I've just bought these shoes and they cost a fortune. .....
3 Could you keep an eye on my bag for me? .....
4 The answer's on the tip of my tongue. .....
5 We had a night on the town last night. .....
6 I could do with a new computer; mine's quite old now. .....

76 Fixed phrases in conversation

A Common responses

A large number of fixed phrases are used as common responses in everyday conversation.

A: What time did he get here?
B: **I've no idea**. [I don't know]

A: Are you going tonight?
B: **That depends**. [used to say you are not sure because other things affect your answer; also **It depends**]

A: Shall we go out tonight?
B: Yeah, **why not** [OK]?

A: Did you like the film?
B: **Not really**. [used to say *no* but not strongly]

A: I'm going to Sweden next week.
B: Really. **What for?** [why?]

A: Can I borrow your car?
B: **No way**. [that's impossible; *infml*; *syn* **no chance**]

A: They're coming tonight, aren't they?
B: **I suppose so**. [used to say *yes* but not strongly]

A: Jason has grown a beard.
B: I know. **I couldn't believe my eyes!** [I was very surprised when I saw it]

A: We have to work tonight.
B: **You must be joking**.

A: Eli got top marks.
B: **I don't believe it**! [used to express great surprise]

Language help

We can use **you must be joking** (*syns* **you're joking**/**kidding**) when someone has just said something that is a surprise. It may be an unpleasant surprise (as above), or a nice surprise, e.g.
A: My father said he would pay for all of us to go on holiday.
*B: **You're kidding**. Fantastic!*

B In conversation

Notice how fixed phrases can form an important part of an everyday conversation.

A: I had to **have a word with** Vince and Milan today. [speak to them without others listening]
B: Oh yeah? Are they causing trouble again?
A: Well, **you know**, [used to fill a pause in conversation] they just keep talking to each other, and they don't **pay attention** [listen] – **that sort of thing**.
B: Why don't you make them sit in different places?
A: I tried that, but they still talked to each other.
B: Well, **in that case** [because of the situation described], you'll have to move one of them.
A: Maybe, but I'd **feel bad about** that [be unhappy about]. They're quite nice boys, you know, they just **can't help it** [can't control some actions or behaviour].
B: Sure … but you can't let **that kind of thing** continue.
A: No, you're right. But I've given them a final warning today, so let's **wait and see** what happens. [wait to discover what will happen]
B: OK. But **what if** they don't improve? [what will you do if they don't improve?]
A: I think it'll be OK.
B: Well, if you **change your mind** [change your decision], come and see me again, and I'll arrange for one of them to be moved to another class.



Language help

We use **sort**/**kind** in several common phrases in informal speech.
(**and**) **that sort**/**kind of thing** [examples of that type]
e.g. *I grow onions and carrots – **that sort/kind of thing**.*
sort/**kind of** [approximately/more or less] e.g. *Her new top is **sort of** blue; I thought he was **kind of** strange.*

Exercises

76.1 Put the responses in the most suitable column below.

~~no way~~	not really	I suppose so	why not
you're kidding	that depends	I don't believe it	

positive	negative	not sure or either
	no way	

76.2 Choose the correct word. Sometimes both are correct.

1 I need to have a *word* / *speak* with Catalina.
2 I don't know what they plan to do; we'll have to wait and *see* / *watch*.
3 He usually wears jeans, trainers, and that *sort* / *kind* of thing.
4 Little children shout and scream all the time; they can't *help* / *leave* it.
5 A: I went to Cambridge last week. B: Really? *What* / *Why* for?
6 The trouble with Mark is that he doesn't *pay* / *give* attention.
7 A: Are you working tonight? B: *It* / *That* depends.

76.3 Complete the dialogues with a suitable fixed phrase.

1 A: Did you hear that Daniel's getting married?
B: Yeah. *I don't believe it!*
2 A: Sofia doesn't listen.
B: No. She never ..... .
3 A: Did you speak to Nathalie?
B: Yes, I ..... .
4 A: Dad wasn't happy about forgetting my birthday.
B: No, he felt ..... .
5 A: Do you know what time he'll be here?
B: No, I'm afraid I've ..... .
6 A: Are you still planning to sell the flat?
B: No, I've ..... . I'm going to keep it now.

76.4 Where could you add the phrases in the box to the dialogues below?

~~you know~~	I couldn't believe my eyes	kind of	in that case
that sort of thing	you must be joking	why not	

1 A: What did you say to him?
B: Well, ∨ it was quite difficult. *you know*
2 A: What colour was it?
B: Blue.
3 A: He's not coming this evening, so you won't be able to ask him.
B: Well, I'll phone him and ask him.
4 A: Jerry says we'll have to walk all the way to the campsite.
B: That's ten miles!
5 A: Do you want to get a takeaway?
B: Yeah.
6 A: What do they sell?
B: Oh, burgers, pizzas, …
7 A: Did you see Chloe wearing those high-heeled shoes?
B: Yes.

77 Verb or adjective + preposition

A Verb + preposition

Pay special attention to prepositions that are different in your language.

Paul doesn't like the manager's decision and I **agree with** him. [have the same opinion as]
Don't **worry about** your exam. [be nervous about]
His teachers were **satisfied with** his progress. [pleased with]
Many people **spend** a lot of money **on** clothes.
I'**m thinking of** go**ing** to China. [it's my plan to go] (used in the continuous form)
This land **belongs to** the company. [it is the company's land]
I **translated** the letter **into** French. [changed from one language into another]
She **complained to** the manager **about** the food. [said she wasn't happy/satisfied with]
I can't **concentrate on** [think about] my work when the radio is playing.
We can **rely on** this photocopier. [trust it; it will not go wrong]
I may go but it **depends on** the weather. [used to say you are not sure about something]

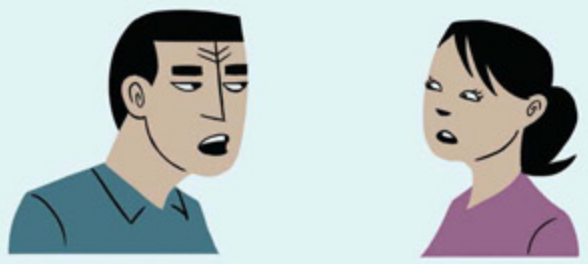
Language help

Depend (on) has other meanings:
*Martha **depends on** her son for money.* [she <u>needs</u> his money]
*We can **depend on** the others for support.* [we can <u>trust</u> the others to support us]
Remember: it **depends on** something or someone (NOT it depends ~~of~~ something or someone)

B Prepositions that change the meaning



She **shouted to** me. [spoke in a loud voice to be heard]



He **shouted at** me. [spoke in a loud voice because he was angry]



He **threw** the ball **to** me. [for me to catch it]



He **threw** the ball **at** me. [in order to hit me]

C Adjective + preposition

I've never been very **good at** maths. (*opp* **bad at**)
She's **afraid of** flying. [frightened of]
The neighbours **are fond of** the children. [like]
She's **similar to** her sister [the same as her in some ways], but very **different from** her brother.
He's very **interested in** photography.
I think she**'s aware of** the problem. [knows about]
I'm **tired of** people telling me what to do. [bored or a bit angry about]
Katya **is mad about** Brad Pitt. [likes him very much; *infml*]
We**'re short of** coffee at the moment. [we don't have much]
There's **something wrong with** this TV. [the TV is not working correctly]

Exercises

77.1 Match the sentence beginnings on the left with the best endings on the right.

1	He's tired	c	a me, but it missed.
2	She wasn't aware		b to the manager.
3	He threw the pen to		c of working at weekends.
4	She complained		d his friend on the other side of the lake.
5	He shouted at		e me, but I dropped it.
6	He shouted to		f with them.
7	He threw the book at		g us to get out of his garden.
8	I don't agree		h of her mistakes.

77.2 Complete the questions with the correct preposition, then write an answer for each one.

1	A: What is she worried *about*?	B: *Her exams.*
2	A: What subjects is she good ____?	B: ____
3	A: Who does this belong ____?	B: ____
4	A: What does he spend all his money ____?	B: ____
5	A: What are you afraid ____?	B: ____
6	A: What kind of films are you interested ____?	B: ____
7	A: What does the decision depend ____?	B: ____
8	A: I know he's angry, but who's he shouting ____?	B: ____
9	A: Who can we rely ____?	B: ____
10	A: What language is the book being translated ____?	B: ____

77.3 Complete the dialogues.

1 A: Are you going to the exhibition?
B: Yes, I'm very *interested* in art.

2 A: Is she ____ to her sister?
B: No, they're completely different.

3 A: What did she ____ about?
B: She wasn't happy with the food.

4 A: Angel is very good-looking.
B: That's why I'm ____ about him!

5 A: What's ____ with the radio?
B: I don't know, but it's not working.

6 A: Did you like the course?
B: No, I wasn't very satisfied ____ it.

7 A: What's the matter?
B: I can't ____ on this with the TV on.

8 A: It's a big problem.
B: Yes, but we're ____ of that.

9 A: We're a bit ____ of milk.
B: OK. I'll buy some when I go out.

10 A: Do Max's children have jobs?
B: No, they still ____ on their parents.

77.4 Do you know which preposition follows the words below? They are all in this book. If you don't know, use the index to help you. A good dictionary will tell you if a verb or adjective is usually followed by a special preposition.

keen ____ succeed ____ apply ____
suffer ____ get married ____ apologise ____

77.5 Over to you

Complete the sentences about yourself. If possible, compare your answers with someone else.

1 I'm not very good ____.

2 I've always been interested ____.

3 I'm not very fond ____.

4 I spend most of my money ____.

5 For my next holiday, I'm thinking ____.

78 Prepositional phrases

A *By*, *on* or *in* + noun

I took his pen **by mistake** [I thought it was my pen].
These shoes are made **by hand** [not using a machine].
I met them **by chance** [it wasn't planned; it was luck].



He broke the plate **by accident** [he did not want or plan to do it].



He broke the plate **on purpose** [he wanted to do it; it was his intention].

My boss is **on the phone** at the moment. [using the phone]
The workers are **on strike** [they refuse to work because of a problem over pay, hours, etc.].
The books were **on display** in the window. [in the window for people to look at]
Part of the building was **on fire** [burning].
Most of the passengers are now **on board** [on the train, boat, plane, etc.].
Why are they always **in a hurry** [needing to do something or go somewhere very quickly]?
I explained everything **in detail** [including all the important information].
She won't make that mistake again **in future**.
The poor little girl was **in tears** [crying].

B Phrases easily confused

Sometimes two prepositions can be used with the same noun, but the meaning is different.

Lessons begin at 8.30 and the students are usually here **on time** [at 8.30].
If we hurry, we'll be there **in time** [before the time we need to be there].

We were tired of waiting, so **in the end** we went home. [finally, after a lot of time or thought]
At the end of the book they get married. [in the last part]

To be successful **in business** it's important to get on well with people. [working as businesspeople]
They're both in Germany **on business** [they are there for work, not a holiday].

I'm afraid this book's a bit **out-of-date** [old and not useful, or not correct in its information].
I try to keep **up-to-date** with all the changes. [knowing all the most recent ideas and information]

I'll see you **in a moment** [not now, but very soon; *syn* **in a minute**].
I can't speak to you **at the moment** [now; *syn* **right now**].

Common mistakes

I'm busy **at the moment**. (NOT I'm busy ~~in this~~ moment.)

Exercises

78.1 Put the nouns into the correct columns.

~~board~~	hand	accident	display	detail
fire	future	mistake	tears	strike

on	in	by
board		

78.2 Choose the correct word to complete the sentences.

1 I'm afraid I deleted your email *on / in / by* accident.
2 Did she hit him *on / by / in* purpose?
3 I just saw them *with / by / on* chance.
4 Most of these files are *out-of- / out-from- / out-for-* date.
5 My wife is away *in / on / by* business at the moment.
6 I'm afraid I'm busy *on / in / at* the moment.
7 I've got to go; I'm *in / on / at* a hurry.
8 I won't go there again *on / in / at* future.

78.3 Complete the missing noun in these prepositional phrases.

1 I saw smoke coming out of the window, and I realised the house was on *fire*.
2 Nobody is at the factory. The workers are all on .....
3 These chocolates are expensive because they are all made by .....
4 I'm just going to the shop but I'll be back in a .....
5 I'm sure she broke that vase on ..... ; she never liked it.
6 I'm sorry I can't stop to talk now – I'm in a .....
7 She never thanked me for the present, so I won't buy her another one in .....
8 You can't trust things you read on the Internet; a lot of the information there is out-of- .....
9 I told them everything they wanted to know. I explained it all in .....
10 I went to the exhibition, and some of Katya's paintings were on .....
11 The manager can't speak to you at the ..... ; I'm afraid she's on the .....
12 It was a terrible journey but we got there in the .....

78.4 Replace the underlined word(s) with a prepositional phrase.

1 The meeting was planned for 11 am and we got there <u>at 11 am</u>. *on time*
2 Did you get to the cinema <u>before the film started</u>? .....
3 Most of the factory is <u>burning</u>. .....
4 I had great difficulty finding the camera I wanted, so <u>finally</u> I bought one on the Internet. .....
5 He gets killed <u>in the last scene</u> of the film. .....
6 I'm afraid I'm very busy <u>right now</u>. .....
7 I saw her yesterday <u>but we didn't plan to meet</u>. .....
8 I'm writing an email, but I'll be with you <u>very soon</u>. .....
9 Most of these books are <u>old and the information is wrong</u>. .....
10 I explained the system <u>with all the important information</u>. .....

79 Phrasal verbs 1: form and meaning

A Formation

A phrasal verb is a verb + adverb or preposition, and sometimes a verb + adverb *and* preposition.

He **fell over** [fell to the ground] and hurt his knee.
I'll try to **find out** [learn/discover] the quickest way to get there.
He didn't like his coat, so he **gave** it **away** [gave it to someone for no money].
If you don't understand the meaning, **look** it **up** [find the meaning in a book/dictionary].
Who's going to **sort out** the problem? [deal with it successfully; solve it]
He doesn't **get on with** [have a good relationship with] his parents. (verb + adv. + prep.)

B Meaning

The adverb or preposition does not always change the meaning of the verb, and is not always used.

I didn't **wake** (**up**) until 7 o'clock.
Hurry (**up**) or we'll be late.
She's **saving** (**up**) for a new computer.
I went to **lie** (**down**) on the bed.

Sometimes an adverb adds a particular meaning to the verb. For example, **back** can mean *return*.

I bought this jacket yesterday, but I'm going to **take** it **back** to the shop; it's too small.
You can look at the books, but remember to **put** them **back** on the shelf.
They liked Greece so much they want to **go back** next year.

Often, the adverb or preposition changes the meaning of the verb: *give up* doesn't mean the same as *give*, and *carry on* doesn't mean the same as *carry*.

My wife has decided to **give up** [stop] smoking.
We'll take a short break and then **carry on** [continue] with the meeting.
The shops are going to **put up** [increase] the price of bread.
When the hotel gets busy, we have to **take on** [employ] more staff .

C Multiple meanings

Many phrasal verbs have more than one meaning.

go away
I was busy, so I told him to **go away** [leave].
We try to **go away** in August. [go on holiday]

Pick something /someone up
I **picked up** most of the rubbish. [lifted it from the floor]
I'm going to **pick** Jane **up** at the station. [collect someone, usually in a car]

Put something on
Could you **put** the light **on** [make a piece of equipment work by pressing a switch; *syn* **switch sth on**]?
I **put on** my best suit. [put clothes on your body]



Exercises

79.1 **Choose the correct adverb or preposition to complete the sentence.**

1	I can't see. Could you put the light ..... ?	a in	b on	c out
2	If he doesn't want it, he can give it	a out	b away	c up
3	Have they sorted it ..... ?	a out	b over	c up
4	It was broken, so I had to take it	a over	b on	c back
5	I went to the airport to pick her	a up	b down	c over
6	What time did you wake ..... ?	a to	b up	c for
7	I get married next year. I need to start saving	a out	b on	c up
8	Could you switch the TV ..... ?	a down	b on	c in

79.2 **Replace the underlined word(s) with a phrasal verb that keeps a similar meaning.**

1 We never <u>discovered</u> what it means. *found out*
2 I'd like to <u>return</u> next year. .....
3 We <u>collected</u> Mia from the station. .....
4 We'll have to <u>increase</u> the price this year. .....
5 I've decided to <u>stop</u> eating chocolate. .....
6 Is Hana going to <u>continue</u> with her English course? .....
7 I told them to <u>leave</u>. .....
8 I <u>have a good relationship</u> with my parents. .....
9 We are planning to <u>employ</u> ten new drivers next year. .....

79.3 **Look at the dictionary entry for *go off* and match the meanings with the sentences below.**

a When the light goes off, the machine has finished. *3*
b My alarm clock went off early this morning. .....
c I think this meat has gone off. .....
d The bomb went off without any warning. .....
e Beatriz went off early; she had to meet a friend. .....

go off

1 Leave
to leave a place and go somewhere else
She's gone off to the cafe with Tony.

2 Food *UK informal*
If food goes off it is not good to eat anymore because it is too old.

3 Stop
If a light or machine goes off, it stops working.
The heating goes off at 10 o'clock.

4 Explode
If a bomb or gun goes off, it explodes or fires.

5 Make noise
If something that makes a noise goes off, it suddenly starts making a noise.
His car alarm goes off every time it rains.

79.4 **Complete the dialogues.**

1 A: Can you afford that bike?
B: No, I'll have to *save up* for it.
2 A: Is there still a problem?
B: Don't worry. I'll ..... it ..... .
3 A: Can we look at some books?
B: Yes, but ..... them ..... afterwards.
4 A: Did you feel unwell?
B: Yes, I had to ..... on the bed.
5 A: What's the matter?
B: I ..... and cut my knee.
6 A: I don't know what this means.
B: Well, ... it ..... in a dictionary.
7 A: Does he look smart?
B: Yes. He's ..... his suit.
8 A: ..... or we'll be late.
B: OK, I'm coming.

80 Phrasal verbs 2: grammar and style

A Phrasal verbs with no object

Some phrasal verbs don't have an object. We cannot put other words between the parts of the verb.

When does your train **get in** [arrive]?
Hold on [wait a moment], I just need to get my coat.
The car **broke down** on my way to work. [stopped working]
I'll **call for** them at 8 o'clock. [go to collect them]
We **set off** [started the journey] about 7.30.

B Phrasal verbs with an object

Many phrasal verbs need an object. We can usually put the object in different positions.

Put on your shoes**.**
Put your shoes **on.**

Turn on the TV**.**
Turn the TV **on.**

Take off your coat**.**
Take your coat **off.**

These are separable phrasal verbs, but if the object is a long phrase, it usually goes at the end, e.g. I **turned off** the lights in the living room. If the object is a pronoun, it must go in the middle, e.g. **Turn** it **off**.

Common mistakes

Put them **on**. (NOT Put ~~on them~~.); **Take** it **off**. (NOT Take ~~off it~~.)

There are some phrasal verbs where the object must come after the phrasal verb.
I will **look after** the children for you. [take care of them]
How did the two men **break into** the shop? [enter the shop using force, e.g. breaking a window]

C In dictionaries

Dictionaries usually show the grammar of a phrasal verb like this:

No object

hang around
(*also UK* hang about)
to spend time somewhere, usually without doing very much:
There's nowhere for teenagers to go, so they just hang around on street corners.

Separable

hand sth out
to give something to all the people in a group:
A girl was handing out leafl ets at the station.

Not separable
(the object must come after the phrasal verb)

get over sth
to begin to feel better after being unhappy or ill:
It took her months to get over the shock of Richard leaving.

D Style

Phrasal verbs are commonly used in spoken and written English. Many phrasal verbs are quite informal, and sometimes there is a single word with the same meaning as a phrasal verb, which sounds more formal. We use this word instead of the phrasal verb in more formal situations.

leave sb/sth out [not include sb/sth; *syn* **omit**], e.g. He made a list of people but left me out.
make sth up [create sth from your imagination; *syn* **invent**], e.g. We had to make up a story.
put sth off [put sth back to a later date; *syn* **postpone**], e.g. They put the game off till Friday.
turn sth/sb down [refuse an off er or request; *syn* **reject**], e.g. I off ered her a job but she turned it down.

Exercises

80.1 **Correct any mistakes with word order in the sentences. Be careful: some are correct.**

1 She asked me to hand ~~out them~~. *hand them out*
2 I've got some boots but I'll put on them later.
3 Could you turn the light on?
4 My boots were tight and I couldn't take off them.
5 We set off very early this morning.
6 Why did they turn down it?
7 The boys were hanging the station around.

80.2 **Replace the underlined word with a phrasal verb that makes the sentence more informal.**

1 Could you <u>wait</u> a minute, please? *hold on*
2 As so many people are ill, I've had to <u>postpone</u> the meeting till next week. .....
3 The teacher told us to <u>invent</u> a story to go with the picture in our books. .....
4 They <u>omitted</u> a number of the names from my list. .....
5 I don't know why he <u>rejected</u> my offer of help. .....
6 The train should <u>arrive</u> by ten o'clock. .....

80.3 **Write a sentence to describe what is happening or what has happened in the pictures.**



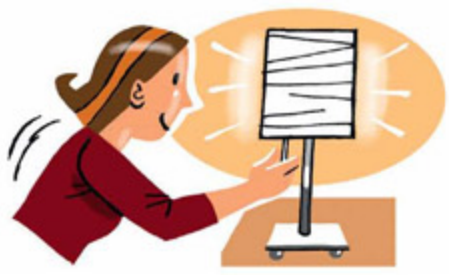
1 *He's putting on his jacket.*



3 .....



5 .....



2 .....



4 .....



6 .....

80.4 **Complete the phrasal verbs.**

1 I'm not stopping, so I won't take *off* my coat.
2 We didn't think Mike was good enough, so we left him ..... .
3 He told me he was 25, but I don't believe him. I think he's making that ..... .
4 We'll get there by seven if we set ..... now.
5 I'll call ..... you a bit later. I should be at your house by 7 o'clock.
6 They offered him the job but he turned it ..... .

80.5 **Complete these sentences in a suitable way.**

1 It was cold so I put on *my gloves/coat/scarf.*
2 Inma is still getting over .....
3 I'm not very good at making up .....
4 She asked me to turn on .....
5 Two men tried to break into .....
6 She's going out, so I said I'd look after .....